0455

National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences

Lahore Campus

Functional English (SS1012)

Date: September 20th, 2025

Course Instructor(s)

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Sessional-1 Exam

Total Time (Hrs.):	**1:00**
Total Marks:	**30**
Total Questions:	**4**

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Attempt all the questions on the answer sheets.

CLO *1: Demonstrate proficiency in reading comprehension.*

Q1: Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. **[7]**

The ability to handle boredom, not surprisingly, is correlated with the ability to focus and to self-regulate. Research has shown that people with attention disorders are particularly prone to boredom. It makes sense that in a hyper-stimulating world, what at first seems captivating now feels less so; what was once mildly diverting may now be flat-out dull. It's especially important that kids get bored and be allowed to stay bored when they're young. That it not be considered "a problem" to be avoided or eradicated by the higher-ups, but instead something kids grapple with on their own. We've stopped training children to do this. Rather than teach them to absorb material that is slower, duller and decidedly two-dimensional, like a lot of worthwhile information is, schools cave in to what they say children expect: fun. Teachers spend more time concocting ways to "engage" students through visuals and "interactive learning" tailored to their Candy Crushed attention spans. Kids won't listen to long lectures, goes the argument, so it's on us to serve up learning in easier-to-swallow portions. But surely teaching children to endure boredom rather than ratcheting up the entertainment will prepare them for a more realistic future, one that doesn't raise false expectations of what work or life itself actually entails.

Source: Paul, P. (2019). Let the children get bored. Models for writers (14th ed., pp. 189–194).

a) Write the implied main idea of the passage. /2

b) Write only 2 major supporting details from the passage. /2

c) Identify the author's purpose and justify your choice in your own words using the evidence (at least 2) from the text. [1+2] /3

CLO *1: Demonstrate proficiency in reading comprehension.*

Q2: Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. **[8]**

Going to the gym today is nothing like it used to be back then, you actually went to work out. Now? It's more of a fashion runway with dumbbells. People wear designer leggings that cost more than my monthly grocery bill, and heaven forbid anyone breaks a sweat it might ruin the Instagram photo. In the past, gyms were loud, stinking, and filled with heavy metal machines. Today's gyms? Mood lighting, scented towels, and smoothie bars that serve something called "kale energy shots." We used to lift heavy stuff, now people lift their phones to film their workouts from seventeen angles. And let's not forget the music once, it was gritty rock or nothing at all. Now, it's carefully curated playlists with names like "Zen Cardio Vibes." There's even air conditioning everywhere, because apparently the goal is to burn calories without ever getting uncomfortable. Modern gyms are less about fitness and more about fashion shows with air conditioning. Honestly, it feels like people are training more to look like they go to the gym than to actually be fit. So yes, gyms still exist, but if you're not wearing coordinated active wear and carrying a $60 water bottle, are you even doing fitness right?

Source: Parker, S. (2025, September 14). Modern gyms: From sweat to selfies. The Guardian.

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a) Write the stated main idea of the passage. /2
b) Identify the author's tone and justify your choice in your own words using the evidence (at least 2) from the text. [1+2] /3
c) Identify the author's style and justify your choice in your own words using the evidence (at least 2) from the text. [1+2] /3

CLO 1: *Demonstrate proficiency in reading comprehension.*
Q3: Read the passage given below. The passage is written in a 'Chronological' pattern of organization. Rewrite it by converting it into a 'Cause and Effect' pattern. **[10]**

In 1947, a small group of scientists began experimenting with the possibility of harnessing solar energy. By the early 1950s, their work resulted in the first photovoltaic cell, a device that could convert sunlight into electricity. Though revolutionary, the cell's efficiency was very low, limiting its immediate use. In the 1970s, the world faced a severe oil crisis, and the shortage of traditional fuel sources encouraged governments to invest more heavily in renewable alternatives. During this decade, solar energy gained attention as a practical option rather than a scientific curiosity. In the 1990s, solar panels became more compact, reliable, and slightly affordable, which allowed households in developed countries to install them. The 2000s marked a major turning point. International climate agreements emphasized the urgent need to cut carbon emissions, and nations began adopting solar power on a larger scale. In recent years, researchers have achieved remarkable improvements in solar cell efficiency, while the cost of production has dropped dramatically. Consequently, solar panels are no longer seen as luxury items but as accessible technology. Today, solar power has moved far beyond experimental status and stands as one of the most promising and widely used sources of clean, renewable energy. (Solar energy, (2023)

Source: In Encyclopedia Britannica, https://www.britannica.com/technology/solar-energy)

CLO 1: *Demonstrate proficiency in reading comprehension.*
Q4: Read the paragraph carefully and answer the questions that follow. **[5]**

Climate change, is largely caused by human activities, is now visible across the globe; for example, rising sea levels in Bangladesh have displaced entire coastal communities. One of the earliest causes dates back to the Industrial Revolution, when coal-powered factories, railways, and steamships emitted vast amounts of smoke and gases. By the mid-20th century, the use of oil and gas in cars, airplanes, and power plants caused emissions to surge, and scientists began recording unusual warming in the Earth's atmosphere. This process is explained by the greenhouse effect, in which gases such as carbon dioxide and methane form a heat-trapping blanket around the Earth; naturally, this system keeps the planet habitable, but human activities have made the blanket dangerously thick, leading to melting glaciers, rising seas, and intensified floods and heatwaves. Another powerful cause is deforestation: forests that normally absorb carbon dioxide were cut and burned in regions releasing more carbon and reducing the Earth's natural storage capacity. Although awareness grew through late-20th-century agreements and 21st-century climate summits, emissions continue to rise, making mitigation through renewable energy and adaptation through defenses like sea walls urgent priorities after more than two centuries of harmful choices.

Source: Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, 2021

a) Identify the Dominant Pattern of Organization. [2]
b) Justify your choice (dominant pattern) in your own words using the evidence (at least 2) from the text. [1+2] [3]

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